Lab: Exploring Job Listings for BI Professionals

Estimated time needed: 30 minutes

Learning objectives:

- Evaluate career opportunities in the field of business intelligence or BI
- Assess the skills, knowledge, and qualifications required for a successful career in BI
- Describe the key responsibilities of a BI analyst

Welcome to the lab: Exploring Job Listings for BI Professionals!

Role of BI professionals

BI professionals gather, transform, and analyze data to derive insights that are used for informed decision-making. They help transform raw data into valuable information that drives business outcomes. BI professionals typically possess skills and expertise in data analysis, data visualization and reporting, business acumen, statistical and analytical skills, data warehousing, communication, and problem-solving skills. The career progression of a BI professional typically includes the roles of a BI analyst, BI developer, BI manager, and head of BI.

Exercise 1: Exploring a job posting for a BI analyst role

A well-known job search portal has posted a job vacancy for a BI analyst with a global investment and asset management leader who is also a Fortune 500® company. Their team has more than 10,000 members and generates more than USD 10 billion in revenue.

From the job description posted on the job posting board, let's look at the roles, responsibilities, and required skills you need to possess for the role of a BI analyst.

To access the job search portal, follow the below-given steps.

1. Log in to the job search portal with your username and password.

2. Enter a keyword, for example, BI analyst, to find jobs in terms of title, keywords, or company, and add specific details such as the town or city where you're seeking a job.

3. Select **Find Jobs**.

4. Review the section **About the job** to check out details about this role.

> ### About the job
>
> **Wish to be a part of our team?**
>
> Analyze data related to complex business problems from various internal and external sources and derive insights to share with decision-makers.
> Identify and infer trends and patterns in datasets to locate influences.
> Draw forecasts, and recommendations and make strategic plans that are based on business data and market know-how.
> Determine specifications for analysis and reports depending on business requirements and data elements that are required or available.
> Offer consultation to users and lead cross-functional teams to resolve business issues.
> Produce datasets and related reports for analysis using BI reporting tools.
> Need to be both operations and external client-focused, and work in tandem with professional services vertical and outsourcing functions.

5. Review the **Key Roles and Responsibilities** section to learn about this role's roles and responsibilities.

> **Key Roles and Responsibilities**
>
> - Analyze complex business problems
> - Gather data from sources including internal and external to provide insights to stakeholders
> - Spot and interpret patterns and trends in the available datasets to find influences
> - Draw specifications to create reports and analysis depending on business needs
> - Define, develop, improve, and monitor various KPIs and metrics using tools such as PowerBI Dashboards and automated Excel
> - Communicate and collaborate with all stakeholders via written and verbal communication

6. Review the **Knowledge, Skills, and Attributes** section to know the knowledge, skills, and other attributes or qualities required for this role.

> **Knowledge, Skills, and Attributes**
>
> - Strong problem-solving, analytical, and communication skills
> - Strong skills to work in MS Excel are a necessity
> - Comfort in general SQL usage and SQL Query is a must
> - Strong PowerBI skills are required
> - Python scripting will be helpful
> - PowerAutomate experience is a plus

- Attention to detail is mandatory
- Curious bent of mind and desire to learn, and ability to manage fast pace and dynamic work environment is a must

7. Review the **Academic Qualifications and Certifications** to understand qualifications and any specific certifications needed for this role.

Academic Qualifications and Certifications

- Bachelor's degree or equivalent experience
- Additional certifications such as:
  - https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/mos-excel-expert-m365-apps/
  - https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/power-bi-data-analyst-associate/
  - https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/azure-ai-fundamentals/

8. Review the **Required Experience** to understand the previous experience required for this role.

Required Experience

- Experience of working in an analytics field
- Experience of SQL
- Experience in creating PowerBI reports and dashboards using multiple data sources
- Experience of creating Excel-based reporting

9. Check out the **Equal Opportunity Employer** section to review how the organization offers equal opportunities.

Equal Opportunity Employer

We take pride in being an Equal Opportunity Employer, encouraging a global culture that wholeheartedly embraces diversity. Our commitment lies in building an environment that is free from any unjust discrimination, or any form of harassment. We hold a steadfast standpoint against discrimination, be it on the basis of age, color, gender, race, religion, disability, pregnancy, national origin, marital status, gender identity, sexual orientation, veteran status, or any other protected category.

Responsibilities of a BI analyst

You will handle the following responsibilities in your career as a BI analyst.

- Prepare complex data and metrics and turn them into easily understandable reports to support data-driven decision-making
- Meeting stakeholders and understanding their business requirements and KPIs. Prior experience in investment and asset management is helpful
- Work as a data domain expert and collaborate with a data engineer to establish data standards and requirements
- Create and manage data aggregation procedures, develop interactive dashboards, and provide a written summary of the findings
- Merge historical data from available industry reports, public information, client interactions, or purchased sources as input for the analysis
- Train, guide, and mentor business users on BI tools
- Promote data literacy and self-service using BI tools to conduct independent basic data analysis
- Collaborate with internal stakeholders to create effective business strategies and their implementation

Exercise 2: Job posting for Senior BI analyst role

A leading company in the Aerospace and Aviation industry has posted a job opening for a Senior BI analyst role on an employment search platform. This industry is responsible for manufacturing components of spacecraft, satellites, and other on-orbit management solutions, including launch services. The company is located in Washington, USA, and has over 1000 employees. Their recent revenue generation is approximately USD 211 million. Let's review the responsibilities and required skills for the senior BI analyst role based on the job description on the board.

To access the job search portal, follow the below-given steps.

1. Log in to the job portal with your username and password.

2. Review the **Senior BI Analyst** section to learn about the job location and role.

Senior BI Analyst

This role will be based out of our WA headquarters. The Senior BI Analyst role is responsible for data analysis and development of BI reports and the relevant datasets. The person needs to provide analytics to various functional teams.

3. Refer to the **What You'll Get To Do** section to review your role and responsibilities as a senior BI analyst.

What You'll Get To Do

- Devise and construct intelligent solutions encompassing both dynamic and static reporting.
- Craft visualizations and reports utilizing advanced BI toolsets.
- Execute rigorous testing and adept troubleshooting.
- Uphold data stewardship with a focus on ownership protocols to guarantee the accuracy of foundational data.

- Collaborate with data engineers in extracting data from diverse sources. Conduct comprehensive analyses to unveil trends, pinpoint weaknesses, suggest improvements, and present data in insightful formats.
- Cultivate and enhance data models to discern relationships within distinct data clusters.
- Demonstrate proficiency in reporting architecture, covering report delivery methods, reusability, calendar-based scheduling, and ad-hoc reporting.
- Collaborate closely with various stakeholders, primarily internal, to propel data analysis and foster process enhancement initiatives.
- Apply adept process refinement techniques across the organization, driving efficiency and output amplification.
- Undertake operational roles or tasks as necessitated.
- Assure data remains secure and access is regulated.

4. Review the section **Required Qualifications** for the required programming language skills, experience, and knowledge of the tools for this role.

Required Qualifications

- Min. 5+ years of working experience as BI Analyst and a relevant bachelor's degree in engineering, computer science, commerce degree or equivalent
- 5+ years of Power BI experience with Power Query and DAX
- Strong/excellent SQL Skills including PL/SQL

5. Review the **Nice to Have Qualifications** section for the advanced skills or qualifications that will be helpful for this role.

Nice to Have Qualifications

- Be able to work with peers and lead initiatives where required.
- Proven communication skills and the ability to build strong working relationships.
- Ability to work independently or with the team
- Finance, Manufacturing or Supply Chain knowledge and experience.
- Experience of Power BI Administration
- Agile experience
- MS SSRS experience

6. Refer to the **Additional Requirements** section for information about travel availability and the possibility of working longer hours.

Additional Requirements

- There will be travel requirements off and on, hence, the ability to work outside of work hours is an added advantage
- Finance, Supply Chain, or Manufacturing knowledge and experience
- Agile experience
- Experience of Power BI Administration

7. Review the **Additional Requirements** section to find out about the expected salary range.

Additional Requirements

The expected salary range for the position is displayed in accordance with the State's Equal Pay for Equal Work Act. Final agreed upon compensation is based upon individual qualifications and experience.

In addition to base salary, the company offers a total compensation package depending on individual qualifications and experience, which may include cash perks, or equity incentives. Employees will also be eligible for medical, vision coverage, dental, 401(k) retirement plan options, and stock options.

Base Pay Range

$105,000 — $140,000 USD

Responsibilities of a Senior BI analyst

You will handle the following responsibilities in your career as a senior BI analyst.

- Knowledge of the data steward role, which is a part of the data governance group
- Ensure data security and access control
- Perform analyses to discover trends and identify weaknesses or improvements, provide solutions, and present data in meaningful ways
- Work on the four analytics models and tools to discover trends in data
- Maintain and develop data models to identify relationships between different data groups
- Integrate data from various sources
- Good knowledge of scale-and-reuse data models to avoid duplicated efforts
- Experience in report architecture
- Excellent knowledge of Power BI administration skills
- Schedule report delivery methods either through the BI tool's report-sharing capabilities
- Work with data engineers to get data from different sources
- Work with internal stakeholders to drive data analysis process improvement activities

Now, you have insights about how to explore various job postings for BI analyst and senior BI analyst roles.

Exploring the domains, industries, and company profiles for a job posting?

1. Log in to a job portal and enter keywords to find jobs matching your skills and location. For example, LinkedIn, Indeed, Naukri.com, Glassdoor, Foundit.com, and so on.
2. Carefully review the job listing and analyze each section to understand the requirements comprehensively.
3. When applying for a job, research the relevant industry and your experience in it, for example, finance, banking, telecommunications, retail, defense, and so on.
4. Gain insights about a company's establishment year, employee count, revenue, offerings, mission, and leadership by perusing their website and blogs.
5. Before applying, review all open positions at the company.
6. Check the company's reviews and the experiences of other employees on the job portal.
7. Gather sufficient information about the company before applying for the job.